

PET TRAVEL GUIDANCE *EFFECTIVE 1 AUG 24*

Effective August 1, 2024, the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) and the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) will require **all dogs, regardless of country they are traveling from, to include countries deemed high, low, or no risk of dog rabies, to be registered online with CDC prior to arriving in the United States**. Dogs entering the United States before or on July 31, 2024, are subject to the current import restrictions outlined in refel. There are no new requirements for cat importation.

The temporary suspension of dogs from high-risk countries will expire when the new regulations become effective on August 1, 2024. Below is a summary of the new requirements that present significant changes from the previous restrictions:

a) **All dogs, to include service dogs, must be registered online prior to entering the United States**. The CDC Dog Import Form is an online form on the CDC's website. Upon successful completion of the form, a receipt will be autogenerated and immediately emailed to the importer. There is no charge to the importer for submitting this form (the form will be accessible beginning on July 15, 2024). Importers must present their CDC receipt upon entry into the United States.

b) All dogs, including service dogs, must:

- be healthy upon arrival;
- be at least 6 months of age;
- have an International Organization for Standardization (ISO)-compatible microchip (implanted prior to any required rabies vaccinations);
- have a CDC Dog Import Form receipt; and
- have additional documents depending on where the dog has been in the last 6 months and whether or not the dog was vaccinated in the United States.

c) U.S. vaccinated dogs that meet these requirements above may enter any U.S. port of entry.

d) In addition to the requirements outlined above, **foreign-vaccinated dogs that have been in a country with a high risk of dog rabies in the six months prior to arriving in the United States must also:**

- **arrive via air at a port of entry** with a CDC-registered Animal Care Facility (ACF) which are: **Atlanta (ATL), Los Angeles (LAX), Miami (MIA), New York (JFK), Philadelphia (PHL), and Washington (IAD)**;
- **have a reservation at an ACF prior to arrival**; and
- have a valid rabies titer obtained before arrival from a CDC-approved laboratory. **All dogs, including those with titers, require an ACF visit on arrival for inspection of documents and health assessment of the dog.** Dogs without a valid rabies vaccination certificate or titer must undergo a 28-day quarantine at an ACF upon arrival.

e) **IMPORTANT GRACE PERIOD FOR SUMMER TRANSFER SEASON:** Following the current requirements under the temporary ban expiring on July 31, 2024, foreign-vaccinated dogs coming from

high-risk countries that meet all current requirements, **may request a CDC import permit prior to July 31, 2024**. With this CDC import permit, dogs may enter through one of the 18 approved CDC airports -- Anchorage (ANC), Atlanta (ATL), Boston (BOS), Chicago O'Hare (ORD), Dallas (DFW), Detroit (DTW), Honolulu (HNL), Houston (IAH), Los Angeles (LAX), Miami (MIA), Minneapolis (MSP), New York (JFK), Newark (EWR), Philadelphia (PHL), San Francisco (SFO), San Juan (SJU), Seattle (SEA), Washington DC Dulles (IAD) -- **until August 31, 2024**. A reservation and a health inspection at an ACF are not required. **After August 31, any CDC issued import permit is void and foreign-vaccinated dogs must follow the new requirements outlined in para 3. a), b) and d).**

Dog importers are also reminded to check other federal regulations (e.g. [USDA/APHIS](#)) as well as rabies vaccination requirements of state and local governments for the dog's final destination.

There are no new requirements for cat importation unless a cat is found to be ill or dead enroute to or upon arrival at a U.S. port of entry.

It is imperative that dog owners view the recorded webinar provided by CDC which details these new regulations and procedures at <https://fsi-ex-omis.app.box.com/s/z49s4tcw8gdvckmovi2st9alstrgvvpr>.

Reminder that all pet handling and arrangements are the responsibility of the pet owner. The U.S. government may not assume liability for pets.